

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250284483

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

Beltrame; Bruno Simione et al.

SYSTEMS FOR UPDATING PERIPHERAL DEVICE FIRMWARE

Abstract

Multiple communication modules are used in updating firmware at a peripheral device. A peripheral device firmware version is communicated to a management server via a telematics device. An access location for updated firmware is communicated from the management server to the peripheral device via the telematics device. The peripheral device accesses and downloads the updated firmware via a long-range communication module, not via the telematics device. In this way, regular, minimalistic communication is performed via the telematics device, but major data communication is performed directly by the peripheral device.

Inventors: Beltrame; Bruno Simione (Milton, CA), Fox; Stephen Michael (Oakville, CA), Huang; Xiaowei (Markham, CA), Ivascu; Cristian Florin (Hamilton, CA), Liu; Wenyang (Richmond Hill, CA), Manickam; Sanjeev (Kanata, CA), Omar; Aziz (Hamilton, CA), Roth; Alexander Joshua (Waterloo, CA), Shah; Dharati Bhaumik (Kitchener, CA), Swanson; Robert (Waterloo, CA), Thomas; Jason-Jon Isaac (Mississauga, CA), Willison; Nicholas (Ayr, CA)

Applicant: Geotab Inc. (Oakville, CA)

Family ID: 96949260

Appl. No.: 19/075100

Filed: March 10, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63563631 20240311

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06F8/65 (20180101); G06F8/71 (20180101)

Background/Summary

PRIOR APPLICATION DATA [0001] This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/563,631, titled “Systems, Devices, and Methods for Updating Peripheral Device Firmware”, filed on Mar. 11, 2024.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure generally relates to systems, devices, and methods for updating firmware data, and in particular relates to updating firmware of peripheral devices.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Peripheral devices can employ firmware to control operation thereof. It is desirable to be able to update such firmware as needed to optimize performance of such peripheral devices. Further, it is desirable to be able to perform these updates using existing connections or communication hardware at the peripheral devices, such that a change in connection to peripheral devices does not need to be established for the purposes of updating firmware.

SUMMARY

[0004] According a broad aspect, the present disclosure describes a system comprising: a management server having a first at least one communication module, a first at least one processor, and a first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing first processor-executable instructions thereon; a telematics device having a second communication module, a third communication module, a second at least one processor, and a second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing second processor-executable instructions thereon; and a peripheral device having a fourth communication module, a fifth communication module, a third at least one processor, and a third at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing third processor-executable instructions thereon, wherein: the third processor-executable instructions cause the peripheral device to: transmit, by the fourth communication module for reception at the telematics device, an indication of a first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device; the second processor-executable instructions cause the telematics device to: receive, by the second communication module, the indication of the first firmware version from the peripheral device; and transmit, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the indication of the first firmware version; the first processor-executable instructions cause the management server to: receive, by the first at least one communication module, the indication of the first firmware version from the telematics device; compare, by the first at least one processor, the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device; and in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, transmit, by the first at least one communication module for reception at the telematics device, an identification of an access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to: receive, by the third communication module, the identification of the access location from the management server; and transmit, by the second communication module, the identification of the access location for reception at the peripheral device; and the third processor-executable instructions further cause the peripheral device to: receive, by the fourth communication module, the identification of the access location from the telematics device; retrieve, by the fifth communication module, the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the access location; and update, by the third at

least one processor, the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location.

[0005] The fourth communication module and the second communication module may comprise respective wired communication modules, for wired communication between the telematics device and the peripheral device.

[0006] The fourth communication module and the second communication module may comprise respective short-range wireless communication interfaces.

[0007] The fifth communication module may comprise a first cellular modem at the peripheral device which communicates over a first cellular network. The third communication module may comprise a second cellular modem at the telematics device which communicates over the first cellular network or a second cellular network different from the first cellular network.

[0008] The first at least one communication module may comprise a network module which communicatively couples to a cloud network or the internet.

[0009] The indication of the access location may comprise a uniform resource locator (URL).

[0010] The access location may comprise the first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

[0011] The access location may comprise a fourth at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium at a datastore remote from the peripheral device, the telematics device, and the management server.

[0012] The peripheral device may further comprise at least one image sensor.

[0013] The peripheral device and the telematics device may be positioned at a vehicle, and the management server and the access location may be remote from the vehicle.

[0014] The fifth communication module may normally be in an inactive mode where communication with the management server is not enabled, and the third processor-executable instructions which cause the peripheral device to retrieve the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version may further cause the peripheral device to: operate the fifth communication module in an active mode where communication with the management server is enabled. The third processor-executable instructions may further cause the peripheral device to: after retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version, operate the fifth communication module in the inactive mode.

[0015] The second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to: receive vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected; and transmit, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the vehicle identification information; and the first processor-executable instructions which cause the management server to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device may cause the first at least one processor to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information.

[0016] The second firmware version may be a most recent firmware version.

[0017] The third processor-executable instructions which cause the fourth communication module to transmit the indication of the first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device may cause the fourth communication module to transmit the indication of the first firmware version in response to waking of the peripheral device.

[0018] The third processor-executable instructions which cause the third at least one processor to update the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location may cause the third at least one processor to update the firmware installed at the peripheral device after deactivation of vehicle where the peripheral device is positioned.

[0019] The first processor-executable instructions may further cause the management server to: access, at a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server, a stored indication of an assumed firmware version for firmware installed at the peripheral device;

compare the assumed firmware version indicated in the stored indication to the second firmware version set for distribution; and in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the assumed firmware version indicated in the stored indication, transmit, by the first at least one communication module for reception at the telematics device, an indication for firmware action at the peripheral device; the second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to: receive, by the third communication module of the telematics device, the indication for firmware action; and in response to receiving the indication for firmware action, transmit, by the second communication module, a wake command; the third processor-executable instructions may further cause the peripheral device to: receive, by the fourth communication module, the wake command; and wake the peripheral device; and the third processor-executable instructions which cause the fourth communication module of the peripheral device to transmit the indication of the first firmware version may cause the fourth communication module to transmit the indication of the first firmware version in response to the peripheral device being woken.

[0020] The second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to store, by the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium, the indication of the first firmware version received from the peripheral device; the second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to access the indication of the first firmware version from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium; and the second processor-executable instructions which cause the third communication module of the telematics device to transmit the indication of the first firmware version may cause the third communication module to transmit the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

[0021] According to another broad aspect, the present disclosure describes a system comprising: a management server having a first at least one communication module, a first at least one processor, and a first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing first processor-executable instructions thereon; and a telematics device having a second communication module, a third communication module, a second at least one processor, and a second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing second processor-executable instructions thereon, wherein: the second processor-executable instructions cause the telematics device to: receive, by the second communication module, an indication of a first firmware version of firmware installed at a peripheral device communicatively coupled to the telematics device; and transmit, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the indication of the first firmware version; the first processor-executable instructions cause the management server to: receive, by the first at least one communication module, the indication of the first firmware version from the telematics device; compare, by the first at least one processor, the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device; and in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, transmit, by the first at least one communication module for reception at the telematics device, an identification of an access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; and the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to: receive, by the third communication module, the identification of the access location from the management server; and transmit, by the second communication module, the identification of the access location for reception and subsequent retrieval of the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the access location by the peripheral device.

[0022] The second communication module may comprise a wired communication module, for wired communication between the telematics device and the peripheral device.

[0023] The second communication module may comprise a short-range wireless communication module.

[0024] The third communication module may comprise a cellular modem at the telematics device

which communicates over a cellular network.

[0025] The first at least one communication module may comprise a network module which communicatively couples to a cloud network or the internet.

[0026] The indication of the access location may comprise a uniform resource locator (URL).

[0027] The access location may comprise the first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

[0028] The access location may comprise another at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium at a datastore remote from the peripheral device, the telematics device, and the management server.

[0029] The telematics device may be positioned at a vehicle where the peripheral device is positioned, and the management server and the access location are remote from the vehicle.

[0030] The second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to: receive vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected; and transmit, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the vehicle identification information; and the first processor-executable instructions which cause the management server to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device may cause the first at least one processor to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information.

[0031] The second firmware version may be a most recent firmware version.

[0032] The second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to store, by the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium, the indication of the first firmware version; the second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to access the indication of the first firmware version from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium; and the second processor-executable instructions which cause the third communication module of the telematics device to transmit the indication of the first firmware version may cause the third communication module to transmit the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

[0033] According to yet another broad aspect, the present disclosure describes a method performed between a management server having a first communication module, a telematics device having a second communication module and a third communication module, and a peripheral device have a fourth communication module and a fifth communication module, the method comprising: transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device to the second communication module of the telematics device, an indication of a first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device; transmitting, by the third communication module of the telematics device to the first communication module of the management server, the indication of the first firmware version; comparing, by a first at least one processor of the management server, the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device; in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, transmitting, by the first at least one communication module of the management server to the third communication module of the telematics device, an identification of an access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; transmitting, by the second communication module of the telematics device, the identification of the access location to the fourth communication module of the peripheral device;

[0034] retrieving, by the fifth communication module of the peripheral device, the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the access location; and updating, by a second at least one processor at the peripheral device, the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location.

[0035] The fifth communication module may normally be in an inactive mode where

communication with the management server is not enabled, and retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version may further comprise: operating the fifth communication module in an active mode where communication with the management server is enabled.

[0036] The third processor-executable instructions may further cause the peripheral device to: after retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version, operating the fifth communication module in the inactive mode.

[0037] The method may further comprise: receiving, by the telematics device, vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected; and transmitting, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the vehicle identification information, and comparing the first firmware version of the peripheral device to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device may comprise comparing the first firmware version of the peripheral device to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information.

[0038] Transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device to the second communication module of the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device may comprise transmitting the indication of the first firmware version in response to waking of the peripheral device.

[0039] Updating, by the second at least one processor, the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location may comprise updating the firmware installed at the peripheral device after deactivation of vehicle where the peripheral device is positioned.

[0040] The method may further comprise: accessing, at a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server, a stored indication of an assumed firmware version for firmware installed at the peripheral device; comparing, by the first at least one processor, the assumed firmware version indicated in the stored indication to the second firmware version set for distribution; in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the assumed firmware version indicated in the stored indication, transmitting, by the first at least one communication module for reception at the telematics device, an indication for firmware action at the peripheral device; receiving, by the third communication module of the telematics device, the indication for firmware action; in response to receiving the indication for firmware action, transmitting, by the second communication module, a wake command; receiving, by the fourth communication module, the wake command; and waking the peripheral device. Transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device, the indication of the first firmware version may comprise transmitting the indication of the first firmware version in response to the peripheral device being woken.

[0041] The method may further comprise: storing, by the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version received from the peripheral device; and accessing, by the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium. Transmitting, by the third communication module of the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version may comprise transmitting the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

[0042] According to another broad aspect, the present disclosure describes a system comprising: a management server having a first at least one communication module, a first at least one processor, and a first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing first processor-executable instructions thereon; a telematics device having a second communication module, a third communication module, a second at least one processor, and a second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing second processor-executable instructions

thereon; and a peripheral device having a fourth communication module, a fifth communication module, a third at least one processor, and a third at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium storing third processor-executable instructions thereon, wherein: the third processor-executable instructions cause the peripheral device to: transmit, by the fourth communication module for reception at the telematics device, an indication of a first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device; the second processor-executable instructions cause the telematics device to: receive, by the second communication module, the indication of the first firmware version from the peripheral device; and transmit, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the indication of the first firmware version; the first processor-executable instructions cause the management server to: receive, by the first at least one communication module, the indication of the first firmware version from the telematics device; compare, by the first at least one processor, the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device; and in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, transmit, by the first at least one communication module for reception at the telematics device, a firmware action message; the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to: receive, by the third communication module, the firmware action message from the management server; and transmit, by the second communication module, a wake command for reception at the peripheral device; and the third processor-executable instructions further cause the peripheral device to: receive, by the fourth communication module, the wake command from the telematics device; wake the peripheral device in response to the wake command; transmit, by the fourth communication module, a request for firmware data access location for reception at the telematics device; the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to: receive, by the second communication module, the request for firmware data access location; transmit, by the third communication module, the request for firmware data access location for reception at the management server; the first processor-executable instructions further cause the management server to: receive, by the first communication module, the request for firmware data access location from the telematics device; transmit, by the first communication module for reception at the telematics device in response to the request for firmware data access location, an indication of an access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to: receive, by the third communication module, the indication of the access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the management server; and transmit, by the second communication module, the indication of the access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version for reception at the peripheral device; and the third processor-executable instructions further cause the peripheral device to: receive, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device, the indication of the access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; retrieve, by the fifth communication module, the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the access location; and update, by the third at least one processor, the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location.

[0043] The fourth communication module and the second communication module may comprise respective wired communication modules, for wired communication between the telematics device and the peripheral device. The fourth communication module and the second communication module may comprise respective short-range wireless communication interfaces.

[0044] The fifth communication module may comprise a first cellular modem at the peripheral device which communicates over a first cellular network. The third communication module may comprise a second cellular modem at the telematics device which communicates over the first cellular network or a second cellular network different from the first cellular network. The first at least one communication module may comprise a network module which communicatively couples

to a cloud network or the internet.

[0045] The indication of the access location may comprise a uniform resource locator (URL).

[0046] The firmware data access location may comprise the first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

[0047] The firmware data access location may comprise a fourth at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium at a datastore remote from the peripheral device, the telematics device, and the management server.

[0048] The peripheral device may further comprise at least one image sensor.

[0049] The peripheral device and the telematics device may be positioned at a vehicle, and the management server and the access location may be remote from the vehicle.

[0050] The fifth communication module may normally be in an inactive mode where communication with the management server is not enabled, and the third processor-executable instructions which cause the peripheral device to retrieve the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version may further cause the peripheral device to: operate the fifth communication module in an active mode where communication with the management server is enabled. The third processor-executable instructions may further cause the peripheral device to: after retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version, operate the fifth communication module in the inactive mode.

[0051] The second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to: receive vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected; and transmit, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the vehicle identification information; and the first processor-executable instructions which cause the management server to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device may cause the first at least one processor to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information.

[0052] The second firmware version may be a most recent firmware version.

[0053] The first processor-executable instructions may further cause the management server to: store, at a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server, an indication of the first firmware version; and access, at the non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server, the stored indication of the first firmware version; and the first processor-executable instructions which cause the first at least one processor to compare the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution may cause the first at least one processor to compare the first firmware version indicated in the stored indication to the second firmware version set for distribution.

[0054] The second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to store, by the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium, the indication of the first firmware version received from the peripheral device; the second processor-executable instructions may further cause the telematics device to access the indication of the first firmware version from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium; and the second processor-executable instructions which cause the third communication module of the telematics device to transmit the indication of the first firmware version may cause the third communication module to transmit the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

[0055] According to yet another broad aspect, the present disclosure describes a method performed between a management server having a first communication module, a telematics device having a second communication module and a third communication module, and a peripheral device having a fourth communication module and a fifth communication module, the method comprising: transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device to the second communication module of the telematics device, an indication of a first firmware version of

firmware installed at the peripheral device; transmitting, by the third communication module of the telematics device to the first communication module of the management server, the indication of the first firmware version; comparing, by a first at least one processor of the management server, the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device; in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, transmitting, by the first at least one communication module of the management server to the third communication module of the telematics device, a firmware action message; transmitting, by the second communication module of the telematics device, a wake command to the fourth communication module of the peripheral device; waking the peripheral device in response to the wake command; transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device, a request for firmware data access location to the second communication module of the telematics device; transmitting, by the third communication module of the telematics device, the request for firmware data access location to the first communication module of the management server; transmitting, by the first communication module of the management server in response to the request for firmware data access location to the third communication module of the telematics device, an indication of an access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; transmitting, by the second communication module of the telematics device to the fourth communication module of the peripheral device, the indication of the access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; retrieving, by the fifth communication module of the peripheral device, the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the access location; and updating, by a second at least one processor at the peripheral device, the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location.

[0056] The fifth communication module may normally be in an inactive mode where communication with the management server is not enabled, and retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version may further comprise: operating the fifth communication module in an active mode where communication with the management server is enabled. The method may further comprise: after retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version, operating the fifth communication module in the inactive mode.

[0057] The method may further comprise: receiving, by the telematics device, vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected; and transmitting, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the vehicle identification information. Comparing the first firmware version of the peripheral device to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device may comprise comparing the first firmware version of the peripheral device to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information.

[0058] The second firmware version may be a most recent firmware version.

[0059] The method may further comprise: storing, at a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server, an indication of the first firmware version; and accessing, at the non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server, the stored indication of the first firmware version. Comparing, by the first at least one processor, the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution may cause the first at least one processor to compare the first firmware version indicated in the stored indication to the second firmware version set for distribution.

[0060] The method may further comprise: storing, by the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version received from the peripheral device; and accessing, by the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium. Transmitting, by the third communication module of the telematics device, the indication

of the first firmware version may comprise transmitting the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0061] Exemplary non-limiting embodiments are described with reference to the accompanying drawings in which:

[0062] FIG. 1 is a schematic view of a telematics system.

[0063] FIG. 2 is a schematic view of a system of devices which are pertinent to a vehicle, in accordance with at least one illustrated example.

[0064] FIG. 3 is a schematic view of a system of devices which communicate with each other, in accordance with at least one illustrated example.

[0065] FIG. 4 is a flowchart diagram of a method for updating firmware at a peripheral device.

[0066] FIG. 5 is a flowchart diagram of a method for sending a wake command to a peripheral device.

[0067] FIG. 6 is a flowchart diagram of a method for requesting an access location for and obtaining firmware data.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0068] The present disclosure details systems, methods, and devices for updating firmware at peripheral devices. The present disclosure sees particular value in vehicle data collection systems, where telematics devices and coupled peripheral devices are positioned at vehicles.

[0069] Telematics systems have been employed by fleet owners to monitor use and performance of vehicles in the fleet. A telematics system monitors a vehicle using an onboard telematics device for gathering and transmitting vehicle operation information. For instance, fleet managers can employ telematics to have remote access to real time operation information of each vehicle in a fleet. A vehicle may include a car, truck, recreational vehicle, heavy equipment, tractor, snowmobile or other transportation asset. A telematics device may detect environmental operating conditions associated with a vehicle, for example, outside temperature, attachment status of an attached trailer, and temperature inside an attached refrigeration trailer. A telematics device may also detect operating conditions of an associated vehicle, such as position, (e.g., geographic coordinates), speed, and acceleration, time of day of operation, distance traveled, stop duration, customer location, idling duration, driving duration, among others. Hence, the telematics device collects and transmits data to the telematics system that is representative of the vehicle operation and usage execution. This data may be collected over a time period of sufficient duration to allow for pattern recognition of the vehicle's operation. In an example the duration may be determined to be a number of days between 30 days and 90 days, though in practice any appropriate number of days could be implemented as the duration.

[0070] In an exemplary telematics system, raw vehicle data, including vehicle operation information indicative of a vehicle's operating conditions, is transmitted from an onboard telematics device to a remote subsystem, (e.g., data management system which may comprise a cloud system or a management system). Raw vehicle data may include information indicating the identity of the onboard telematics device (e.g., device identifier, device ID) and/or the identity of the associated vehicle the onboard telematics device is aboard. Specific and non-limiting examples of raw vehicle data includes device ID data, position data, speed data, ignition state data, (e.g. indicates whether vehicle ignition is ON or OFF), and datetime data indicative of a date and time vehicle operating conditions were logged by the telematics device. Raw vehicle data transmitted and collected over a period of time forms historical vehicle data which may be stored by the remote subsystem for future analysis of a single vehicle or fleet performance. In practice, a single fleet

may comprise many vehicles, and thus large volumes of raw vehicle data (e.g., terabytes, petabytes, exabytes . . .) may be transmitted to, and stored by, a remote subsystem. Throughout this application, vehicle data collected, processed, and/or transmitted by a telematics monitoring device can be broadly included in “telematic data”, among other types of data such as location data discussed later.

[0071] In other exemplary telematics systems, a telematics device can have at least one processing unit thereon which processes or filters raw vehicle data, and transmits processed or filtered data. Such systems can reduce the bandwidth required for transmission and required storage capacity for transmitted data.

[0072] The use of telematics systems has resulted in improved performance and maintenance of vehicles in the fleet. Additionally, data from telematics systems can also be useful to analyze traffic, to provide information for infrastructure design, planning, and implementation.

[0073] Illustrated in FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram of an exemplary telematics system for gathering and storing vehicle operation information. Telematics system **100** comprises telematics subsystem **102** having a first network interface **108** and onboard telematics devices **104** of vehicles **114** communicatively coupled therewith via communication network **110**.

[0074] The telematics subsystem **102** in an implementation comprises a management system which is a managed cloud data warehouse for performing analytics on data stored therein. In another implementation, the management system may comprise a plurality of management systems, datastores, and other devices, configured in a centralized, distributed or other arrangement. In some implementations, one or more different management systems may be employed and configured separately or in a centralized, distributed or other arrangement. In the illustrated example, telematics subsystems **102** includes at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **120** and at least one processor **122**. The at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **120** can store data on which analytics is performed, and/or can store instructions thereon. Said instructions, when executed by the at least one processor **122**, cause the telematics subsystem to perform the desired operations, analysis, or data collection/aggregation. The telematics subsystem **102** can also be referred to as a management server. Such a management server can be a single device, or can be a distributed arrangement as discussed above.

[0075] Communication network **110** may include one or more computing systems and may be any suitable combination of networks or portions thereof to facilitate communication between network components. Some examples of networks include, Wide Area Networks (WANs), Local Area Networks (LANs), Wireless Wide Area Networks (WWANs), data networks, cellular networks, voice networks, among other networks, which may be wired and/or wireless. Communication network **110** may operate according to one or more communication protocols, such as, General Packet Radio Service (GPRS), Universal Mobile Telecommunications Service (UMTS), GSM, Enhanced Data Rates for GSM Evolution (EDGE), LTE, CDMA, LPWAN, Wi-Fi™, Bluetooth™, Ethernet, HTTP/S, TCP, and CoAP/DTLS, or other suitable protocol. Communication network **110** may take other forms as well.

[0076] Telematics system **100** may comprise another network interface **109** for communicatively coupling to another communication network **112**. In an implementation, communication network **112** may comprise a communication gateway between the fleet owners and the telematics system **100**.

[0077] Also shown in FIG. 1 are vehicles **114**, each thereof having aboard the onboard telematics devices **104**. A vehicle may include a car, truck, recreational vehicle, heavy equipment, tractor, snowmobile, or other transportation asset. Onboard telematics devices **104** may transmit raw vehicle data associated with vehicles **114** through the communication network **110** to the telematics subsystem **102**.

[0078] Three telematics devices **104** are described in this example for explanation purposes only and embodiments are not intended to be limited to the examples described herein. In practice, a

telematics system may comprise many vehicles **114**, such as hundreds, thousands and tens of thousands or more. Thus, huge volumes of raw vehicle data may be received and stored by remote telematics subsystem **102**.

[0079] In general, telematics devices **104** comprise sensing modules configured for sensing and/or measuring a physical property that may indicate an operating condition of a vehicle. For example, sensing modules may sense and/or measure a vehicle's position, (e.g., GPS coordinates), speed, direction, rates of acceleration or deceleration, for instance, along the x-axis, y-axis, and/or z-axis, altitude, orientation, movement in the x, y, and/or z direction, ignition state, transmission and engine performance, and times of operation among others. One of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that these are but a few types of vehicle operating conditions that may be detected.

[0080] Telematics device **104** may comprise a sensing module for determining vehicle position. For instance, the sensing module may utilize Global Positioning System (GPS) technology (e.g., GPS receiver) for determining the geographic position (Lat/Long coordinates) of vehicle **114**.

Alternatively, the sensing module utilizes another a global navigation satellite system (GNSS) technology, such as, GLONASS or BeiDou. Alternatively, the sensing module may further utilize another kind of technology for determining geographic position. In addition, the sensing module may provide other vehicle operating information, such as speed. Alternatively, the telematics device **104** may communicate with a plurality of sensing modules for a vehicle.

[0081] Alternatively, vehicle position information may be provided according to another geographic coordinate system, such as, Universal Transverse Mercator, Military Grid Reference System, or United States National Grid.

[0082] In general, a vehicle **114** may include various control, monitoring and/or sensor modules for detecting vehicle operating conditions. Some specific and non-limiting examples include, an engine control unit (ECU), a suspension and stability control module, a headlamp control module, a windscreen wiper control module, an anti-lock braking system module, a transmission control module, and a braking module. A vehicle may have any combination of control, monitoring and/or sensor modules. A vehicle may include a data/communication bus accessible for monitoring vehicle operating information, provided by one or more vehicle control, monitoring and/or sensor modules. A vehicle data/communication bus may operate according to an established data bus protocol, such as the Controller Area Network bus (CAN-bus) protocol that is widely used in the automotive industry for implementing a distributed communications network. Specific and non-limiting examples of vehicle operation information provided by vehicle monitoring and/or sensor modules include, ignition state, fuel tank level, intake air temp, and engine RPM among others.

[0083] Telematics device **104** may comprise a monitoring module operable to communicate with a data/communication bus of vehicle **114**. The monitoring module may communicate via a direct connection, such as, electrically coupling, with a data/communication bus of vehicle **114** via a vehicle communication port, (e.g., diagnostic port/communication bus, OBDII port). Alternatively, the monitoring module may comprise a wireless communication interface for communicating with a wireless interface of the data/communication bus of vehicle **114**. Optionally, a monitoring module may communicate with other external devices/systems that detect operating conditions of the vehicle.

[0084] Telematics device **104** may be configured to wirelessly communicate with telematics subsystem **102** via a wireless communication module. In some embodiments, telematics device **104** may directly communicate with one or more networks outside vehicle **114** to transmit data (such as telematic data) to telematics subsystem **102**. A person of ordinary skill will recognize that functionality of some modules may be implemented in one or more devices and/or that functionality of some modules may be integrated into the same device.

[0085] Telematics devices **104** may transmit raw vehicle data (or telematic data), indicative of vehicle operation information collected thereby, to telematics subsystem **102**. The raw vehicle data may be transmitted at predetermined time intervals, (e.g. heartbeat), intermittently, and/or

according to other predefined conditions. Raw vehicle data (or telematic data) transmitted from telematics devices **104** may include information indicative of device ID, position, speed, ignition state, and date and time operating conditions are logged, for instance, in an onboard datastore. One of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that raw vehicle data may comprise data indicative of numerous other vehicle operating conditions. Raw vehicle data may be transmitted from a monitoring device when a vehicle is moving, stationary, and during both ON and OFF ignition states.

[0086] Also shown in FIG. **1** are image sensors **134**, each aboard a respective vehicle **104**. Each of image sensors **134** could for example be a camera, such as a video camera. Such image sensors capture image data (or video data, as a sequence of images) in a field of view of the respective image sensor. In some cases, an image sensor is positioned and oriented to capture image data representing a field of view outside the vehicle (e.g. a dash cam, rear view cam, or other camera pointed externally to the vehicle). In some cases, an image sensor is positioned and oriented to capture image data representing a field of view inside the vehicle (e.g. a driver-facing camera, a camera aimed at an instrument panel, or other camera pointed internally in the vehicle).

[0087] Similar to telematic data, image data captured by image sensors **134** can be transmitted to telematics subsystem **102** by communications network **110**. In some implementations, communication hardware of telematics devices can have limited bandwidth capabilities. For example, transmission speed or quantity from a telematics device **104** can be throttled to reduce power consumption. As another example, a telematics device **104** may be old, such that the communication hardware thereon is inherently limited in capabilities. In such cases, communication hardware of the telematics device **104** may be inadequate or inappropriate for transmitting image data from an image sensor **134** over communications network **110**. To address this, image sensors **134** may include dedicated communication hardware for communicating over communications network **110**. This is described in detail with reference to FIG. **2** below.

[0088] FIG. **2** is a schematic diagram which illustrates an exemplary system **200**, where a peripheral device and telematics device are positioned at a vehicle and able to communicate with a management server remote from the vehicle. In particular, FIG. **2** shows a vehicle **210**. In the illustrated example, vehicle **210** is a sedan-type car, but this discussion applies to any appropriate type of vehicle, such as those discussed earlier. A telematics device **220** is positioned at vehicle **210**. The telematics device **220** could be installed (permanently or removably) to the vehicle **210**. For example, the telematics device may comprise a monolithic device which plugs into a data port of vehicle **210** (such as the OBDII port) to receive power and data from the vehicle. As another example, the telematics device may comprise multiple components positioned in different locations of the vehicle which communicate with each other. A peripheral device **230** is also positioned at vehicle **210**. In the illustrated example, the peripheral device **230** is an image capture device installed to vehicle **210** so as to look out the front windshield of vehicle **210**. In alternative implementations, more than one image capture device can be positioned at the vehicle, pointed in any appropriate direction (e.g. a rear-facing camera, in-cab facing camera, side facing cameras, etc.) A plurality of image capture devices can be implemented collectively as a peripheral device (e.g. the image capture devices are controlled commonly), or as a plurality of respective peripheral devices. In alternative implementations, the peripheral device could comprise at least one device which is not an image capture device, such as peripheral sensors, a peripheral battery device, a key activation or storage device, or any other appropriate device. Telematic device **220** and peripheral device **230** are communicatively coupled with each other; detailed implementations are discussed later with reference to FIG. **3**.

[0089] FIG. **2** also shows a management server **290**. As discussed earlier with reference to telematics subsystem **102**, management server **290** can comprise one device, or can comprise a plurality of devices or distributed computing resources (e.g. over a cloud or server warehouse). Telematic device **220** and peripheral device **230** are each communicatively coupled to management

server **290**. While FIG. 2 illustrates this communicative coupling in a direct manner, the communicative coupling can be indirect (e.g. over a communication network such as a cellular or internet network).

[0090] FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram showing a system **300** including exemplary hardware for the management servers, telematics devices, and peripheral devices discussed herein. The hardware shown in FIG. 3 is not exhaustive, and any appropriate additional hardware can be included in each of the devices.

[0091] FIG. 3 shows a management server **310**, which includes a first at least one processor **312**, a first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **314**, and a first communication module **316**. The first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **314** can store (among other data) processor-executable instructions which, when executed by the first at least one processor **312**, control operation of the management server **310** (e.g. cause the management server **310** to perform any appropriate actions, such as actions in methods **400**, **500**, and/or **600** discussed later with reference to FIGS. 4, 5, and 6).

[0092] FIG. 3 also shows a telematics device **320**, which includes a second at least one processor **322**, a second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **324**, a second communication module **326**, and a third communication module **328**. Telematics device **320** also includes means for receiving, collecting, or capturing telematics data as described earlier. In the illustrated example in FIG. 3, telematics device **320** includes a data port **321**, which connects to a corresponding port of a vehicle (e.g. a diagnostics port such as an OBDII port), in order to receive vehicle-related data from the vehicle. Also in the illustrated example, telematics device **320** includes at least one sensor **323**, which captures sensor data related to the vehicle (such as location data, inertial data, or any other appropriate type of sensor data as discussed earlier). The second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **324** can store (among other data) processor-executable instructions which, when executed by the second at least one processor **322**, control operation of the telematics device **320** (e.g. cause the telematics device **320** to perform any appropriate actions, such as actions in methods **400**, **500**, and/or **600** discussed later with reference to FIGS. 4, 5, and 6).

[0093] FIG. 3 also shows a peripheral device **330** which includes at least one third processor **332**, at least one third non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **334**, a fourth communication module **336**, and a fifth communication module **338**. Peripheral device **330** can be any appropriate type of peripheral device (e.g. image capture device, battery device, processing device, key-storage device, as non-limiting examples). To this end, peripheral device **330** can also include any hardware appropriate to enable peripheral device **330** to serve its intended purpose. The third at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **334** can store (among other data) processor-executable instructions which, when executed by the third at least one processor **332**, control operation of the peripheral device **330** (e.g. cause the peripheral device **330** to perform any appropriate actions, such as actions in methods **400**, **500**, and/or **600** discussed later with reference to FIGS. 4, 5, and 6).

[0094] The labels “first”, “second”, “third”, “fourth”, and “fifth” are merely to label different components, and do not indicate or imply any specific sequence or ordinance of components.

[0095] The first communication module **316**, third communication module **328**, and fifth communication module **338** are long-range communication modules, for communication between management server **310** and telematics device **320** and/or peripheral device **330**. For example, communication modules **316**, **328**, and **338** can be cellular modems, which enable communication of management server **310**, telematics device **320**, and peripheral device **330** over at least one cellular network. Such a cellular network is one example of communication network **390** shown in FIG. 3, via which management server **310** communicates with telematics device **320** and peripheral device **330**. Communication network **390** is optional, and in some implementations management server **310** could communicate directly with telematics device **320** and peripheral device **330**, as

also shown in FIG. 3 by dashed lines. The first communication module **316**, third communication module **328**, and fifth communication module **338** do not all have to be the same type of modules, nor is communication network **390** limited to a single communication network. For example, communication module **316** can be an internet capable module (e.g. an ethernet port, a wireless network module such as a WiFi™ module, or any other appropriate module) which connects to the internet; communication module **328** can be a cellular module which connects to a cellular network of a first cellular provider; and communication module **338** can be a cellular module which connects to a cellular network of a second cellular provider. In such an implementation, each of the first communication module **316**, third communication module **328**, and fifth communication module **338** connect to the internet and communicate over the internet, but via different mechanisms.

[0096] Second communication module **326** and fourth communication module **336** are generally short-range communication modules. In some implementations, second communication module **326** and fourth communication module **336** can be wired communication modules (such as USB ports), such that telematics device **320** and peripheral device **330** communicate with each other over a wired connection. In other implementations, second communication module **326** and fourth communication module **336** are wireless communication modules, such as Bluetooth™, Zigbee™, WiFi™, or any other appropriate type of short-range wireless connection.

[0097] FIG. 4 is a flowchart diagram which illustrates an exemplary method **400** for updating firmware at a peripheral device. Method **400** as illustrated includes acts performed by a management server **410** (illustrated as acts **411**, **412**, **413**, **414**, **415**, and **416**), acts performed by a telematics device **420** (illustrated as acts **421**, **422**, **423**, **424**, **425**, and **426**), and acts performed by a peripheral device **430** (illustrated as acts **431**, **432**, **433**, **434**, **435**, **438**, and **439**). One skilled in the art will appreciate that additional acts could be added, acts could be removed, or acts could be reordered as appropriate for a given application. For example, acts **438**, **414**, **423**, **424**, **432**, **415**, and **439** are optional, and could be selectively removed or replaced as appropriate for a given application.

[0098] With reference to the examples illustrated in FIGS. 1, 2, and 3, acts can be performed by appropriate components of systems such as system **100** in FIG. 1, system **200** in FIG. 2, and/or system **300** in FIG. 3. For example, acts of transmission, reception, or retrieval can be performed by appropriate communication modules; acts of preparing messages, comparison, determination, installing, or updating can be performed by an appropriate at least one processor; acts of storing or providing access can be performed by an appropriate at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium. Further, any of the discussed at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage mediums, can have processor-executable instructions stored thereon, which when executed by a respective at least one processor cause a respective device or component to perform a given act of method **400**.

[0099] In the context of method **400**, firmware is installed at the peripheral device **430**. The installed firmware is of a first firmware version, and an indication of the first firmware version can be stored on at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the peripheral device (such as non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **334** in FIG. 3).

[0100] At **438**, the peripheral device **430** optionally wakes up. This act is optional, in the sense that in some implementations the peripheral device **430** is already awake or is already otherwise active. In scenarios where act **438** is included, prior to method **400** the peripheral device is in a sleep or low power mode. In some cases, peripheral device **438** is completely deactivated (non-powered) prior to method **400**. In some cases, certain functionality or components (e.g. communication module **338**) of peripheral device **430** are disabled or non-active so reduce power consumption and/or save connection bandwidth.

[0101] Waking the peripheral device **430** at act **438** can be performed in a variety of ways. In a first exemplary implementation, activation of the vehicle where peripheral device **430** is installed

triggers waking of the peripheral device **430**. For example, telematics device **420** connects to a vehicle data port (such as the OBDII port, via data port **321** discussed with reference to FIG. **3**). Telematics device **420** receives an indication of activation of the vehicle via the data port. In response to activation of the vehicle, the telematics device sends a wakeup command to the peripheral device **430**, which causes the peripheral device to wake at **438**.

[0102] The telematics device can receive any appropriate form of activation signal from the vehicle. For example, the telematics device **420** can receive an explicit ignition signal which indicates that the ignition of the vehicle has been activated. As another example, the telematics device **420** can identify activation of the vehicle based on other signals, such as a battery voltage signal from which the telematics device **420** identifies a cranking event of an ignition of the vehicle. As yet another example, the telematics device **420** can receive a signal which explicitly indicates a state of the vehicle, such as Accessory mode or Drive mode, which indicates activation of the vehicle.

[0103] In a second exemplary implementation, waking the peripheral device **430** can be performed even when the vehicle is off (e.g. an ignition of the vehicle is not activated). For example, telematics device **420** can send a wakeup command to peripheral device **430**, such as in response to an identified need to update firmware at peripheral device **430** as discussed later with reference to FIG. **5**. Such an implementation advantageously keeps peripheral device firmware up to date, even if the vehicle is seldom used.

[0104] At **431**, the peripheral device **430** transmits an indication of a first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**. This transmission is intended for reception at telematics device **420**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device (such as the fourth communication module **336** in FIG. **3**). The transmission can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the peripheral device **430** (for example, the at least one processor **332** in FIG. **3** can retrieve the stored first firmware version and package a message indicating the first firmware version for transmission).

[0105] At **421**, the indication of the first firmware version from the peripheral device **430** is received by the telematics device **420**, by a communication module which can communicate with the peripheral device **430** (such as second communication module **326** in FIG. **3**). Throughout this disclosure, acts of “receiving” data or information can include any appropriate aspects of such reception, such as intaking, formatting, decompressing, processing, interpreting, or any other actions, as appropriate in a given context.

[0106] At **422**, the telematics device **420** transmits the indication of the first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**. This transmission is intended for reception at management server **410**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the management server (such as the third communication module **328** in FIG. **3**). In some implementations, the telematics device **420** can forward the indication received from the peripheral device **430** at **421** (e.g., without interpretation or processing by the telematics device **420**). In other implementations, the telematics device **420** (e.g. by the at least one processor **322** in FIG. **3**) can process the indication received from the peripheral device **430** at **421**, and prepare another indication of the first firmware version for transmission to the management server (for example, the telematics device **420** may reformat a message indicating the first firmware version, for optimal transmission to the management server **410** over a corresponding communication module).

[0107] In yet other implementations, the telematics device **420** can optionally store the indication of the first firmware version received at **421** in a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium thereat, shown as medium **429** in FIG. **4** (which can correspond to for example non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **324** in FIG. **3**). The stored indication of the first firmware version can later be accessed, and the indication of the first firmware version transmitted at **422** can be the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **420**. By storing the indication of the first firmware version at telematics

device **420** for later transmission, reporting of the first firmware version by the telematics device **420** to the management server **410** can be delayed (or repeated) relative to when the first firmware version is transmitted from the peripheral device **430** to the telematics device **420**. In this way, the first firmware version can be transmitted from telematics device **420** even if the peripheral device **430** is asleep (not activated). This can be useful in scenarios where the vehicle is not used (activated) for an extended period of time, as discussed in detail later (e.g. with reference to FIG. 5). For example, when a vehicle is not used for an extended period of time, the telematics device **420** may be asleep most of the time, but may wake periodically to send a status update or communication (e.g. every 24 hour, every week, or any other appropriate length of time). The status update or communication can include the first firmware version for firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**. By periodically reporting the first firmware version by the telematics device **420**, even if the peripheral device **430** is asleep, it can be determined at the management server **410** when the peripheral device **430** needs a firmware update.

[0108] The above-discussed scenario where the first firmware version is reported by the telematics device **420** even if the peripheral device **430** is asleep is one exemplary use case, and the peripheral device **430** is not required to be asleep for act **422** to occur.

[0109] At **411**, the indication of the first firmware version from the telematics device **420** is received by the management server **410**, by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device (such as first communication module **316** in FIG. 3). Optionally, the received first firmware version can be stored at a non-processor-readable storage medium **419** accessible to the management server **410** (e.g. non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **314** in FIG. 3, or a network storage medium which management server **410** can communicate with). The first firmware version as stored in non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **419** can be accessed and used for checking firmware version of the peripheral device **430** in the future, for example if the peripheral device **430** is not activated for a long period of time as discussed in more detail later with reference to FIG. 5.

[0110] At **412**, a processor of management server **410** (such as the first at least one processor **312** in FIG. 3) compares the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device. In particular, when firmware updates are released, they can be made available for distribution to peripheral devices (such as by storing the firmware updates at the management server, or at a datastore separate from the management store). In some implementations, the second firmware version corresponds to a most up-to-date (most recent) firmware version which is compatible with the particular peripheral device from which the indication of the first firmware version is received. This most recent firmware version can be set for distribution of peripheral devices at the server. In other implementations, the second firmware version can be set to a firmware version which is not most recent (e.g., an older firmware version, with the intent to rollback firmware installed at peripheral devices). By comparing the first firmware version to the second firmware version at **412**, it can be determined whether the firmware installed at the peripheral device corresponds to the set firmware version (i.e., the firmware version which is indicated as a desired firmware version at the server).

[0111] At **413**, if the second firmware version is not different from the first firmware version (e.g. if the first firmware version and the second firmware version are the same; that is, the firmware installed at the peripheral device already matches the set firmware version), method **400** illustrates different optional implementations for communicating (or not) that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version.

[0112] In one optional implementation the management server **410** communicates to the peripheral device **430** that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version (the second firmware version). In method **400** of FIG. 4, at **414**, the management server **410** transmits an indication that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches a set firmware version (e.g. an indication that the first firmware version matches the second firmware

version). This transmission is intended for reception at telematics device **420**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device (such as the first communication module **316** in FIG. 3). The transmission can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the management server **410** (for example, the at least one processor **312** in FIG. 3 can prepare a message indicating the first firmware version and the second firmware version, or a message indicating the first firmware version and the second firmware version are equal, for transmission).

[0113] At **423**, the indication that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version is received by the telematics device **420**, by a communication module which can communicate with the management server **410** (such as third communication module **328** in FIG. 3).

[0114] At **424**, the telematics device **420** transmits the indication that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version. This transmission is intended for reception at peripheral device **430**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the peripheral device **430** (such as the second communication module **326** in FIG. 3). In some implementations, the telematics device **420** can forward the indication received from the management server at **423** (e.g. without interpretation or processing). In other implementations, the telematics device **420** (e.g. by the at least one processor **322** in FIG. 3) can process the indication received from the management server at **423**, and prepare another indication that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version (for example, the telematics device **420** may reformat a message indicating the firmware match, for optimal transmission to the peripheral device over a corresponding communication module).

[0115] At **432**, the indication that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version, from the telematics device **420**, is received by the peripheral device **430**, by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device **420** (such as fourth communication module **336** in FIG. 3). In this way, the peripheral device **430** is informed that the firmware installed thereat does not need to be changed.

[0116] In another optional implementation, the management server **410** does not communicate to the peripheral device **430** that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version. In particular, at **413** if the second firmware version is the same as the first firmware version of the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**, method **400** ends at **415**. Implicitly, since the peripheral device **430** does not receive an indication to update its firmware, the peripheral device **430** can interpret that the firmware installed thereat does not need to be changed.

[0117] At **413**, if the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, method **400** continues to act **416**, where an updating process is performed to update firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**.

[0118] At **416**, the management server **410** transmits an indication of an access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware. For example, the indication of the access location can be an internet link (e.g. Uniform Resource Locator or URL, or any other appropriate format of access location identifier) which leads to a repository or database where the firmware data is stored. The transmission is intended for reception at telematics device **420**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device (such as the first communication module **316** in FIG. 3). The transmission can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the management server **410** (for example, the at least one processor **312** in FIG. 3 can prepare a message indicating the access location, for transmission).

[0119] At **425**, the indication of the access location is received by the telematics device **420**, by a communication module which can communicate with the management server **410** (such as third communication module **328** in FIG. 3).

[0120] At **426**, the telematics device **420** transmits the indication of the access location. This transmission is intended for reception at peripheral device **430**, and is transmitted by a

communication module which can communicate with the peripheral device **430** (such as the second communication module **326** in FIG. **3**). In some implementations, the telematics device **420** can forward the indication received from the management server at **425** (e.g. without interpretation or processing). In other implementations, the telematics device **420** (e.g. by the at least one processor **322** in FIG. **3**) can process the indication received from the management server at **425**, and prepare another indication of the access location.

[0121] At **433**, the indication of the access location is received by the peripheral device **430**, by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device **420** (such as fourth communication module **336** in FIG. **3**).

[0122] At **434**, the peripheral device **430** retrieves the firmware data for the second firmware version from the access location. For example, where the indication of the access location specifies a link or URL from which the firmware data can be downloaded, a communication module of the peripheral device (e.g. the fifth communication module **338** in FIG. **3**) accesses the link or URL and downloads the firmware data to at least one storage medium (e.g. the at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **334** in FIG. **3**) of the peripheral device.

[0123] The access location can be any appropriate location. In some implementations, the access location is a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the management server (such as the first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **314** in FIG. **3**). This is shown in FIG. **4** with the firmware data being retrieved from management server **410** at **417**. In other implementations, the access location is separate from the management server. For example, the access location can be a remote datastore (e.g. a server which stores firmware for cloud distribution to various devices), such as remote datastore **440** in FIG. **4**, storing the firmware data for the second firmware version at **447**. A remote datastore can be remote from management server **410**, telematics device **420**, and peripheral device **430**, and from a vehicle in which telematics device **420** and peripheral device **430** are positioned.

[0124] At **435**, the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** is updated. For example, a processor of the peripheral device (e.g. the third at least one processor **332** in FIG. **3**) can execute or apply the firmware data retrieved at **434**, to update or replace existing firmware data at the peripheral device (for example firmware data stored on the third at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **334** in FIG. **3**).

[0125] Optionally, prior to updating the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**, the peripheral device **430** can wait until the vehicle is deactivated or not in use as shown at **439**. In particular, updating the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** often entails restarting or otherwise rendering the peripheral device **430** non-functional for a period of time. Peripheral device **430** may perform an important function which should not be interrupted while the vehicle is in use, and as such the update at **435** can be delayed until the vehicle is not in use at **439**. For example, the peripheral device **430** may receive location, speed, or acceleration data (e.g. from an included sensor or from telematics device **420**) which indicates the vehicle is no longer moving. As another example, the peripheral device **430** may receive ignition or vehicle activation data (e.g. from telematics device **420**) which indicates that the vehicle is no longer active. In response to identification that the vehicle is not activated or not in use, the peripheral device **430** can perform act **435** and apply the firmware update based on the firmware data for the second firmware version retrieved at **434**.

[0126] Notably, in method **400** the communication module by which the peripheral device **430** sends the indication of the first firmware version is different from the communication module by which the peripheral device **430** retrieves the firmware data for the second firmware version. That is, the peripheral device **430** sends the indication of the first firmware version to the management server **410** indirectly, via the telematics device **420**. In contrast, the peripheral device **430** retrieves the firmware data for the second firmware version more directly (i.e., not via the telematics device). Such an implementation has a number of advantages discussed below.

[0127] The telematics device communication module which communicates with the management server (e.g. third communication module **328** in FIG. **3**) is already present in telematics-enabled vehicles, and generally at least periodically active, to transmit telematics data to the management server. In contrast, the peripheral device communication module which communicates with the management server (e.g. fifth communication module **338** in FIG. **3**) can generally be in an inactive or deactivated mode (e.g. in a shut down or low-power consumption stand by state where communication with the management server is not enabled), and only transitioned to an active state occasionally when needed (e.g. to retrieve firmware data). As such, retrieving the firmware data as in act **434** of method **400** can comprise operating the communication module which connects to the management server (e.g. communication module **338** in FIG. **3**) in an active mode where communication with the management server is enabled. Such operation can be achieved by transitioning operational mode of the communication module, such as by for example an internal message within the peripheral device. After the firmware data is retrieved, the communication module **338** can be transitioned back to operating in the inactive mode where communication with the management server is not enabled.

[0128] In some implementations, the indication of the first firmware version can be transmitted by the peripheral device **430** periodically (e.g. daily, weekly, monthly), for transmission by the telematics device **420** when the communication module which communicates with the management server **410** is active to transmit telematics data. In other implementations, the indication of the first firmware version can be transmitted by the peripheral device **430** in response to activation of the vehicle and/or activation of the peripheral device **430**, as discussed earlier. In either case, overall power consumption is reduced by only activating one long-range communication module. Further, connection subscription costs can be reduced, by only requiring regular activation of one long-range communication module (the third communication module **328** in FIG. **3**), while keeping another long-range communication module (the fifth communication module **338** in FIG. **3**) in a deactivated or low-power mode until needed on occasion. In such an implementation, a cellular service subscription can be maintained for the long-range communication module of the telematics device, while a different payment model (e.g. a pay-per-use) model could be used for the long-range communication module of the peripheral device.

[0129] In some implementations, method **400** can further comprise the telematics device **420** receiving vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected. In one implementation, a telematics device can comprise a data port (such as data port **321** in FIG. **3**) which communicatively couples to a vehicle (such as vehicle **210** in FIG. **2**), over which the telematics device receives information which can be used to identify the vehicle. For example, a VIN (Vehicle Identification Number) can be received by the telematics device from the vehicle. As another example, while a VIN itself may not always be communicated by a vehicle, VIN can be derived from other operational data received by the telematics device from the vehicle. As yet another example, when the telematics device is installed in the vehicle, the vehicle information can be input or otherwise configured, such that at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the telematics device stores the vehicle identification information. The vehicle identification information is not necessarily limited to VIN (which uniquely identifies a particular vehicle), but can also be information which identifies attributes of a vehicle which are not necessarily unique. For example, the vehicle identification information can indicate make, model, year, fuel type, class, weight, or any other appropriate information about the vehicle.

[0130] The received vehicle identification information is transmitted (e.g. by the third communication interface **328** in FIG. **3**) for reception at the management server. The management server receives the vehicle identification information (e.g. by the first at least one communication interface **316** in FIG. **3**). In such implementations, at **412** in method **400**, comparing the first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device to the second firmware version of firmware set for distribution to the peripheral device comprises comparing the first firmware

version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information. For example, certain peripheral devices which interface with the vehicle may not operate properly if firmware is installed which is not compatible (or tested for compatibility) with the vehicle. As a specific example, a peripheral device could comprise a Bluetooth™ module which provides communication between the telematics device and an infotainment or audio system of the vehicle. If firmware is installed which is not compatible with the infotainment system in a particular vehicle, the functionality of the peripheral device is hindered.

[0131] In some cases, vehicles are not used regularly, and as a result telematics devices and peripheral devices at such vehicles may not activate for extended periods of time. Consequently, firmware at such peripheral devices may not be updated in accordance with method **400** regularly or consistently. FIG. 5 discussed below illustrates a method for updating firmware of such devices.

[0132] FIG. 5 is a flowchart diagram which illustrates an exemplary method **500** for updating firmware at a peripheral device. Method **500** as illustrated includes acts performed by a management server **410** (illustrated as acts **511**, **512**, **513**, **514**, **414**, **415**, and **515**), acts performed by a telematics device **420** (illustrated as acts **521**, **423**, **522**, **523**), and acts performed by a peripheral device **430** (illustrated as act **531**). One skilled in the art will appreciate that additional acts could be added, acts could be removed, or acts could be reordered as appropriate for a given application. For example, acts **414**, **423**, and **415** are optional, and could be selectively removed or replaced as appropriate for a given application.

[0133] Method **500** is shown including a number of acts (acts **414**, **415**, and **423**) which are also included in method **400** in FIG. 4 and discussed above; discussion of these acts earlier is also applicable to method **500**.

[0134] The management server **410**, telematics device **420**, and peripheral device **430** in FIG. 5 are the same as those discussed with reference to method **400** in FIG. 4, and description of these devices with reference to FIG. 4 also applies to FIG. 5.

[0135] Similar to method **400**, in the context of method **500**, firmware is installed at the peripheral device **430**. The installed firmware is of a first firmware version.

[0136] In some implementations, prior to method **500**, an indication of the first firmware version is stored on at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server **410** (shown as **419**, and discussed earlier with reference to FIG. 4). The non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **419** can be included in management server **410** (e.g. as non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **314** in FIG. 3), or can be separate from but accessible to management server **410** (e.g. as a network storage device which management server **410** can communicate with). An indication of the first firmware version can be provided to the management server **410** for example in the context of method **400**, per acts **431**, **421**, **422**, and **411**, and stored at non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **419** as discussed earlier. That is, in such implementations, an instance of method **400** is performed sometime prior to performing method **500**, and the first firmware version as reported by the peripheral device **430** in the prior instance of method **400** is stored accessible to the management server **410** for future use in the context of method **500**.

[0137] In other implementations, prior to method **500**, an indication of the first firmware version is stored on at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the telematics device **420** (shown as **429**, and discussed earlier with reference to FIG. 4). That is, in such implementations, an instance of method **400** is performed sometime prior to performing method **500**, and the first firmware version as reported by the peripheral device **430** in the prior instance of method **400** is stored at the telematics device **420** for future use in the context of method **500**.

[0138] In the above implementations, a first instance of method **400** can be performed some time prior to method **500**. Method **500** is initiated some time later. For example, method **500** could be initiated when the vehicle has not been activated for a set amount of time, such as 24 hours, 7 days,

a month, or any other appropriate amount of time. As another example, method **500** could be initiated when a firmware update or change is made available at the management device **410**. [0139] In the context of FIG. 5, peripheral device **430** is asleep or in a non-active state between times **538** and **539** (e.g. because the vehicle where peripheral device **430** is installed is not activated). While time **538** is shown as being relatively close to act **521** at the start of method **500**, time **538** can be any amount of time prior to method **500**.

[0140] At **521**, telematics device **420** transmits peripheral device information, such as a unique identifier (ID) of peripheral device **430** (or unique identifiers for a plurality of peripheral devices, if connected). This transmission is intended for reception at management server **410**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the management server **410** (such as the third communication module **328** in FIG. 3). Prior to act **521** (e.g. as part of installation or initialization of the peripheral device **430**), the peripheral device information can be stored at a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the telematics device **420** (such as non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **324** in FIG. 3). The transmission of act **521** can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the telematics device **420** (for example, the at least one processor **322** in FIG. 3 can retrieve the stored peripheral device information and package a message indicating the peripheral device information for transmission).

[0141] In some optional implementations where an indication of the first firmware version for firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** is stored at the telematics device **420** (e.g. is stored at non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **429** as discussed earlier as an option with reference to act **421** in method **400**). In such implementations, the first firmware version can be included in (or the focus of) the peripheral device information transmitted at **521**.

[0142] At **511**, the peripheral device information is received by the management server **410**, by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device **420** (such as first communication module **316** in FIG. 3). As discussed earlier, “receiving” data or information can include any appropriate aspects of such reception, such as intaking, formatting, decompressing, processing, interpreting, or any other actions, as appropriate in a given context.

[0143] Optionally, at **512**, the management server **410** accesses an indication of the first firmware version installed at the peripheral device **430**, as stored in the at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **419** as discussed earlier. In particular, where the peripheral device information transmitted at **521** does not include an indication of the first firmware version, the indication of the first firmware version as stored in non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **419** is accessed.

[0144] In some implementations, receiving the peripheral device information at **511** triggers acts **512** and beyond. In such implementations, the received peripheral device information acts as an indicator of when the telematics device **420** is connected to the network (in communication with management server **410**), such that performing a firmware update at peripheral device **430** should be possible (if needed).

[0145] In some implementations, act **512** occurs on a regular or periodic basis (e.g. daily, weekly, monthly, or any other appropriate amount of time). In such implementations, receiving the peripheral device information at **511** acts to provide the management server **410** with an indication of at least one connected peripheral device. For example, method **500** can be performed for a plurality of peripheral devices and telematics devices, and the peripheral device information received from each telematics device can be stored accessible to the management server **410** (e.g. in the at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **419**). The stored peripheral device information in this example effectively acts as a list of peripheral devices for which the firmware version check at **513** in FIG. 5 should be performed (thus preventing management server **410** from performing act **513** for every conceivable peripheral device, some of which may not be installed or connected).

[0146] In some implementations, act **512** and beyond is triggered when a peripheral device

firmware change is made available to management server (e.g. a new firmware version is made available).

[0147] At **513**, the first firmware version installed at peripheral device **430** is compared to a second firmware version set for distribution. The comparison at **513** performed similarly to as discussed regarding act **412** in method **400**, and not repeated for brevity. In some implementations, act **513** can be performed based on the first firmware version as indicated in a transmission from the telematics device **420** (e.g. where an indication of the first firmware version is stored at the telematics device **420** and transmitted to management server **410** with the peripheral device information at **521**). In other implementations, act **513** can be performed based on an indication of the first firmware version as accessed at **512**.

[0148] At **514**, if the second firmware version is not different from the first firmware version (e.g. if the first firmware version and the second firmware version are the same; that is, the firmware installed at the peripheral device already matches the set firmware version), method **500** illustrates different optional implementations for communicating (or not) that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version.

[0149] In one optional implementation the management server **410** communicates to the telematics device **420** that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version (the second firmware version). In method **500** of FIG. 5, at **414**, the management server **410** transmits an indication that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches a set firmware version (e.g. an indication that the first firmware version matches the second firmware version). This transmission is intended for reception at telematics device **420**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device (such as the first communication module **316** in FIG. 3). The transmission can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the management server **410** (for example, the at least one processor **312** in FIG. 3 can prepare a message indicating the first firmware version and the second firmware version, or a message indicating the first firmware version and the second firmware version are equal, for transmission).

[0150] At **423**, the indication that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version is received by the telematics device **420**, by a communication module which can communicate with the management server **410** (such as third communication module **328** in FIG. 3).

[0151] In another optional implementation, the management server **410** does not communicate to the telematics device **420** that the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** matches the set firmware version. In particular, at **514** if the second firmware version is the same as the first firmware version of the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**, method **500** ends at **415**. Implicitly, since the telematics device **420** does not receive an indication the peripheral device **430** needs a firmware update, the telematics device **420** can interpret that peripheral device **430** does not need a firmware update.

[0152] At **514**, if the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, method **500** continues to act **515**, where an updating process is triggered to update firmware installed at the peripheral device **430**.

[0153] At **515**, the management server **410** transmits an indication that firmware action is required at peripheral device **430**. The transmission is intended for reception at telematics device **420**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device **420** (such as the first communication module **316** in FIG. 3). The transmission can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the management server **410**.

[0154] At **522**, the indication that firmware action is required is received by the telematics device **420**, by a communication module which can communicate with the management server **410** (such as third communication module **328** in FIG. 3).

[0155] At **523**, in response to receiving the indication that firmware action is required at **522**, the

telematics device **420** transmits a wake command to the peripheral device **430**. The wake command is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the peripheral device **430** (such as the second communication module **326** in FIG. 3). At **531**, the wake command is received by the peripheral device **430** (e.g. by the fourth communication module **336**). The wake command can be any appropriate command which instructs the peripheral device **430** to go from a sleep or non-active mode (e.g. a low-power mode) to a mode suitable for retrieving and applying firmware updates (e.g. a full power mode).

[0156] In some implementations, in response to receiving the wake command at **531**, method **500** proceeds to method **400** as discussed with reference to FIG. 4 (shown at **541**). In this case, waking up the peripheral device **430** at **438** in method **400** is in response to the wake command received at **531** in method **500**.

[0157] In the course of performing method **400** after method **500**, an indication of the first firmware version installed at the peripheral device **430** is transmitted to the management server **410** (acts **431**, **421**, **422**, and **411**), and this first firmware version is compared to a second firmware version set for distribution (acts **412** and **413**). While this is somewhat redundant with acts **513** and **514** performed in the context of method **500**, there are advantages to this approach.

[0158] Firstly, performing acts **412** and **413** (in method **400**) based on an indication of an installed first firmware version from the peripheral device **430** again after performing acts **513** and **514** confirms the first firmware version installed at the peripheral device **430**. For example, firmware installed at peripheral device could have been manually updated after storing the first firmware version at management server **410** or at telematics device **420**, such that the first firmware version stored at management server **410** or telematics device **420** is not accurate to firmware installed at peripheral device **430**. As another example, firmware at peripheral device **430** may have been updated, but this update may have failed to be reported to management server **410** or telematics device **420** (e.g. due to a communication error).

[0159] Secondly, performing the entirety of method **400** after performing method **500** (despite some redundancy) streamlines implementation, by enabling a multipurpose firmware version and update method (method **400**) to be utilized regardless of the trigger for initiating method **400** (the same method **400** can be utilized to check and update firmware when the vehicle is activated, and when the peripheral device is woken up by the telematics device as in method **500**).

[0160] In some implementations, in response to receiving the wake command at **531**, method **500** proceeds to method **600** as discussed below with reference to FIG. 6 (shown at **542**).

[0161] FIG. 6 is a flowchart diagram which illustrates an exemplary method **600** for updating firmware at a peripheral device. Method **600** as illustrated includes acts performed by a management server **410** (illustrated as acts **611** and **612**), acts performed by a telematics device **420** (illustrated as acts **621**, **622**, **623**, and **624**), and acts performed by a peripheral device **430** (illustrated as acts **631**, **632**, **633**, **634**, and **635**). One skilled in the art will appreciate that additional acts could be added, acts could be removed, or acts could be reordered as appropriate for a given application. Method **600** in FIG. 6 is performed after an instance of method **500** in FIG. 5, as discussed above.

[0162] The management server **410**, telematics device **420**, and peripheral device **430** in FIG. 6 are the same as those discussed with reference to method **400** in FIG. 4 and method **500** in FIG. 5, and description of these devices with reference to FIGS. 4 and 5 also applies to FIG. 6.

[0163] Similar to methods **400** and **500**, in the context of method **600**, firmware is installed at the peripheral device **430**. The installed firmware is of a first firmware version. Prior to **639**, peripheral device **430** is asleep or in a non-active state (e.g. operating in a low power mode, because the vehicle is not activated). Prior to method **600**, the peripheral device **430** receives a wake command from telematics device **420** (shown as **531** in method **500**). In the context of method **600**, the wake command indicates that firmware action is needed at peripheral device **430**.

[0164] At **631**, the peripheral device **430** wakes for firmware action, in response to the wake

command received at **531** in method **500**. At **632**, the peripheral device **430** transmits a request for a firmware data access location (i.e. a location from which the second firmware version data can be downloaded, such as a URL to a firmware repository or network device). The request is to solicit an indication of where the second firmware data can be accessed. This transmission is intended for reception at telematics device **420**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device **420** (such as the fourth communication module **336** in FIG. **3**). The transmission can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the peripheral device **430**, and/or can be based on a stored template.

[0165] At **621**, the request for firmware data access location from the peripheral device **430** is received by the telematics device **420**, by a communication module which can communicate with the peripheral device **430** (such as second communication module **326** in FIG. **3**). Throughout this disclosure, acts of “receiving” data or information can include any appropriate aspects of such reception, such as intaking, formatting, decompressing, processing, interpreting, or any other actions, as appropriate in a given context.

[0166] At **622**, the telematics device **420** transmits the request for firmware data access location. This transmission is intended for reception at management server **410**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the management server **410** (such as the third communication module **328** in FIG. **3**). In some implementations, the telematics device **420** can forward the request received from the peripheral device **430** at **621** (e.g., without interpretation or processing by the telematics device **420**). In other implementations, the telematics device **420** (e.g. by the at least one processor **322** in FIG. **3**) can process the request received from the peripheral device **430** at **621**, and prepare another request for firmware data access location for transmission to the management server **410** (for example, the telematics device **420** may reformat a message requesting firmware data location, for optimal transmission to the management server **410** via communication module **328**).

[0167] At **611**, the request for firmware data access location from the telematics device **420** is received by the management server **410**, by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device (such as first communication module **316** in FIG. **3**).

[0168] At **612**, the management server **410** transmits an indication of firmware data access location for the second firmware version. For example, the indication of the access location can be an internet link (e.g. URL, or any other appropriate format of access location identifier) which leads to a repository or database where the firmware data is stored for the second firmware version. The indication of the access location can be retrieved, for example, for a lookup table or other reference system at the management server **410** which indicates where firmware data can be accessed. This transmission is intended for reception at telematics device **420**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device **420** (such as the first communication module **316** in FIG. **3**). The transmission can be prepared or structured by at least one processor of the management server **410** (for example, the at least one processor **312** in FIG. **3** can prepare a message indicating the access location, for transmission).

[0169] At **623**, the indication of the firmware data access location is received by the telematics device **420**, by a communication module which can communicate with the management server **410** (such as third communication module **328** in FIG. **3**).

[0170] At **624**, the telematics device **420** transmits the indication of the firmware data access location. This transmission is intended for reception at peripheral device **430**, and is transmitted by a communication module which can communicate with the peripheral device **430** (such as the second communication module **326** in FIG. **3**). In some implementations, the telematics device **420** can forward the indication received from the management server at **623** (e.g. without interpretation or processing). In other implementations, the telematics device **420** (e.g. by the at least one processor **322** in FIG. **3**) can process the indication received from the management server at **623**, and prepare another indication of the access location for transmission at **624**.

[0171] At **633**, the indication of the firmware data access location is received by the peripheral device **430**, by a communication module which can communicate with the telematics device **420** (such as fourth communication module **336** in FIG. **3**).

[0172] At **634**, the peripheral device **430** retrieves the firmware data for the second firmware version from the firmware data access location (similarly to as discussed earlier with reference to act **434** in FIG. **4** earlier). For example, where the indication of the access location specifies a link or URL from which the firmware data can be downloaded, a communication module of the peripheral device (e.g. the fifth communication module **338** in FIG. **3**) accesses the link or URL and downloads the firmware data to at least one storage medium (e.g. the at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **334** in FIG. **3**) of the peripheral device **430**.

[0173] The access location can be any appropriate location, similarly to as discussed with reference to FIG. **4**. In some implementations, the firmware data access location is a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the management server **410** (such as the first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **314** in FIG. **3**). This is shown in FIG. **6** with the firmware data being retrieved from management server **410** at **417**. In other implementations, the firmware data access location is separate from the management server **410**. For example, the firmware data access location can be a remote datastore (e.g. a server which stores firmware for cloud distribution to various devices), such as remote datastore **440** in FIG. **6**, storing the firmware data for the second firmware version at **447**. A remote datastore can be remote from management server **410**, telematics device **420**, and peripheral device **430**, and from a vehicle in which telematics device **420** and peripheral device **430** are positioned.

[0174] At **635**, the firmware installed at the peripheral device **430** is updated, similarly to as discussed earlier with reference to act **435** in FIG. **4**. For example, a processor of the peripheral device (e.g. the third at least one processor **332** in FIG. **3**) can execute or apply the firmware data retrieved at **634**, to update or replace existing firmware data at the peripheral device (for example firmware data stored on the third at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium **334** in FIG. **3**).

[0175] In the context of method **500**, proceeding to method **400** at **541** has the advantages discussed earlier, namely simplifying an instruction or function set at the peripheral device, and ensuring the first firmware version assumed by the management device at **513** corresponds to the actual first firmware version at the peripheral device **430**. In contrast, proceeding to method **600** at **542** instead advantageously reduces the number of additional acts to update the firmware at the peripheral device **430** (compared to performing the entirety of method **400** after method **500**), and thus can save processing resources, bandwidth, and power. As a result, whether method **400** or method **600** is performed after method **500** is a tradeoff, with each strategy providing different benefits.

[0176] While the present invention has been described with respect to the non-limiting embodiments, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited to the disclosed embodiments. Persons skilled in the art understand that the disclosed invention is intended to cover various modifications and equivalent arrangements included within the scope of the appended claims. Thus, the present invention should not be limited by any of the described embodiments.

[0177] Throughout this specification and the appended claims, infinitive verb forms are often used, such as “to operate” or “to couple”. Unless context dictates otherwise, such infinitive verb forms are used in an open and inclusive manner, such as “to at least operate” or “to at least couple”.

[0178] The Drawings are not necessarily to scale and may be illustrated by phantom lines, diagrammatic representations, and fragmentary views. In certain instances, details that are not necessary for an understanding of the exemplary embodiments or that render other details difficult to perceive may have been omitted.

[0179] The specification includes various implementations in the form of block diagrams, schematics, and flowcharts. A person of skill in the art will appreciate that any function or

operation within such block diagrams, schematics, and flowcharts can be implemented by a wide range of hardware, software, firmware, or combination thereof. As non-limiting examples, the various embodiments herein can be implemented in one or more of: application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), standard integrated circuits (ICs), programmable logic devices (PLDs), field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), computer programs executed by any number of computers or processors, programs executed by one or more control units or processor units, firmware, or any combination thereof.

[0180] The disclosure includes descriptions of several processors. Said processors can be implemented as any hardware capable of processing data, such as application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), standard integrated circuits (ICs), programmable logic devices (PLDs), field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), logic circuits, or any other appropriate hardware. The disclosure also includes descriptions of several non-transitory processor-readable storage mediums. Said non-transitory processor-readable storage mediums can be implemented as any hardware capable of storing data, such as magnetic drives, flash drives, RAM, or any other appropriate data storage hardware. Further, mention of data or information being stored at a device (e.g. vehicle device **122** or network device **110**) generally refers to the data information being stored at a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of said device (e.g. non-transitory processor-readable storage mediums **116** or **126**).

Claims

1. A method performed between a management server having a first communication module, a telematics device having a second communication module and a third communication module, and a peripheral device having a fourth communication module and a fifth communication module, the method comprising: transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device to the second communication module of the telematics device, an indication of a first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device; transmitting, by the third communication module of the telematics device to the first communication module of the management server, the indication of the first firmware version; comparing, by a first at least one processor of the management server, the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device; in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, transmitting, by the first at least one communication module of the management server to the third communication module of the telematics device, an identification of an access location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; transmitting, by the second communication module of the telematics device, the identification of the access location to the fourth communication module of the peripheral device; retrieving, by the fifth communication interface of the peripheral device, the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the access location; and updating, by a second at least one processor at the peripheral device, the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the fifth communication module is normally in an inactive mode where communication with the management server is not enabled, and retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version further comprises: operating the fifth communication module in an active mode where communication with the management server is enabled.
3. The method of claim 2, further comprising: after retrieving the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version, operating the fifth communication module in the inactive mode.
4. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, by the telematics device, vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected; and transmitting, by the third communication interface for reception at the management server, the vehicle identification information, wherein comparing the first firmware version of the peripheral

device to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device comprises comparing the first firmware version of the peripheral device to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the second firmware version is a most recent firmware version.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device to the second communication module of the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version of firmware installed at the peripheral device comprises transmitting the indication of the first firmware version in response to waking of the peripheral device.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein updating, by the second at least one processor, the firmware installed at the peripheral device based on the firmware data retrieved from the access location comprises updating the firmware installed at the peripheral device after deactivation of vehicle where the peripheral device is positioned.
8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: accessing, at a non-transitory processor-readable storage medium accessible to the management server, a stored indication of an assumed firmware version for firmware installed at the peripheral device; comparing, by the first at least one processor, the assumed firmware version indicated in the stored indication to the second firmware version set for distribution; in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the assumed firmware version indicated in the stored indication, transmitting, by the first at least one communication module for reception at the telematics device, an indication for firmware action at the peripheral device; receiving, by the third communication module of the telematics device, the indication for firmware action; in response to receiving the indication for firmware action, transmitting, by the second communication module, a wake command; receiving, by the fourth communication module, the wake command; and waking the peripheral device, wherein transmitting, by the fourth communication module of the peripheral device, the indication of the first firmware version comprises transmitting the indication of the first firmware version in response to the peripheral device being woken.
9. The method of claim 1, further comprising: storing, by the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium of the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version received from the peripheral device; and accessing, by the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium, wherein transmitting, by the third communication module of the telematics device, the indication of the first firmware version comprises transmitting the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.
10. A system comprising: a management server having a first at least one communication module, a first at least one processor, and a first at least one non-transitory processor readable storage medium storing first processor-executable instructions thereon; and a telematics device having a second communication module, a third communication module, a second at least one processor, and a second at least one non-transitory processor readable storage medium storing second processor-executable instructions thereon, wherein: the second processor-executable instructions cause the telematics device to: receive, by the second communication module, an indication of a first firmware version of firmware installed at a peripheral device communicatively coupled to the telematics device; and transmit, by the third communication module for reception at the management server, the indication of the first firmware version; the first processor-executable instructions cause the management server to: receive, by the first at least one communication module, the indication of the first firmware version from the telematics device; compare, by the first at least one processor, the first firmware version to a second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device; and in response to a determination that the second firmware version is different from the first firmware version, transmit, by the first at least one communication module for reception at the telematics device, an identification of an access

location for firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version; and the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to: receive, by the third communication module, the identification of the access location from the management server; and transmit, by the second communication module, the identification of the access location for reception and subsequent retrieval of the firmware data corresponding to the second firmware version from the access location by the peripheral device.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the second communication module comprises a wired communication module, for wired communication between the telematics device and the peripheral device.

12. The system of claim 10, wherein the second communication module comprises a short-range wireless communication module.

13. The system of claim 10, wherein the third communication module comprises a cellular modem at the telematics device which communicates over a cellular network.

14. The system of claim 10, wherein the first at least one communication module comprises a network module which communicatively couples to a cloud network or the internet.

15. The system of claim 10, wherein the access location comprises the first at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.

16. The system of claim 10, wherein the access location comprises another at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium at a datastore remote from the peripheral device, the telematics device, and the management server.

17. The system of claim 10, wherein the telematics device is positioned at a vehicle where the peripheral device is positioned, and the management server and the access location are remote from the vehicle.

18. The system of claim 10, wherein: the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to: receive vehicle identification information from a vehicle to which the telematics device is connected; and transmit, by the third communication interface for reception at the management server, the vehicle identification information; and the first processor-executable instructions which cause the management server to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device cause the first at least one processor to compare the first firmware version to the second firmware version set for distribution to the peripheral device and compatible with the vehicle identified in the vehicle identification information.

19. The system of claim 10, wherein the second firmware version is a most recent firmware version.

20. The system of claim 10, wherein: the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to store, by the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium, the indication of the first firmware version; the second processor-executable instructions further cause the telematics device to access the indication of the first firmware version from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium; and the second processor-executable instructions which cause the third communication module of the telematics device to transmit the indication of the first firmware version cause the third communication module to transmit the indication of the first firmware version as accessed from the second at least one non-transitory processor-readable storage medium.
